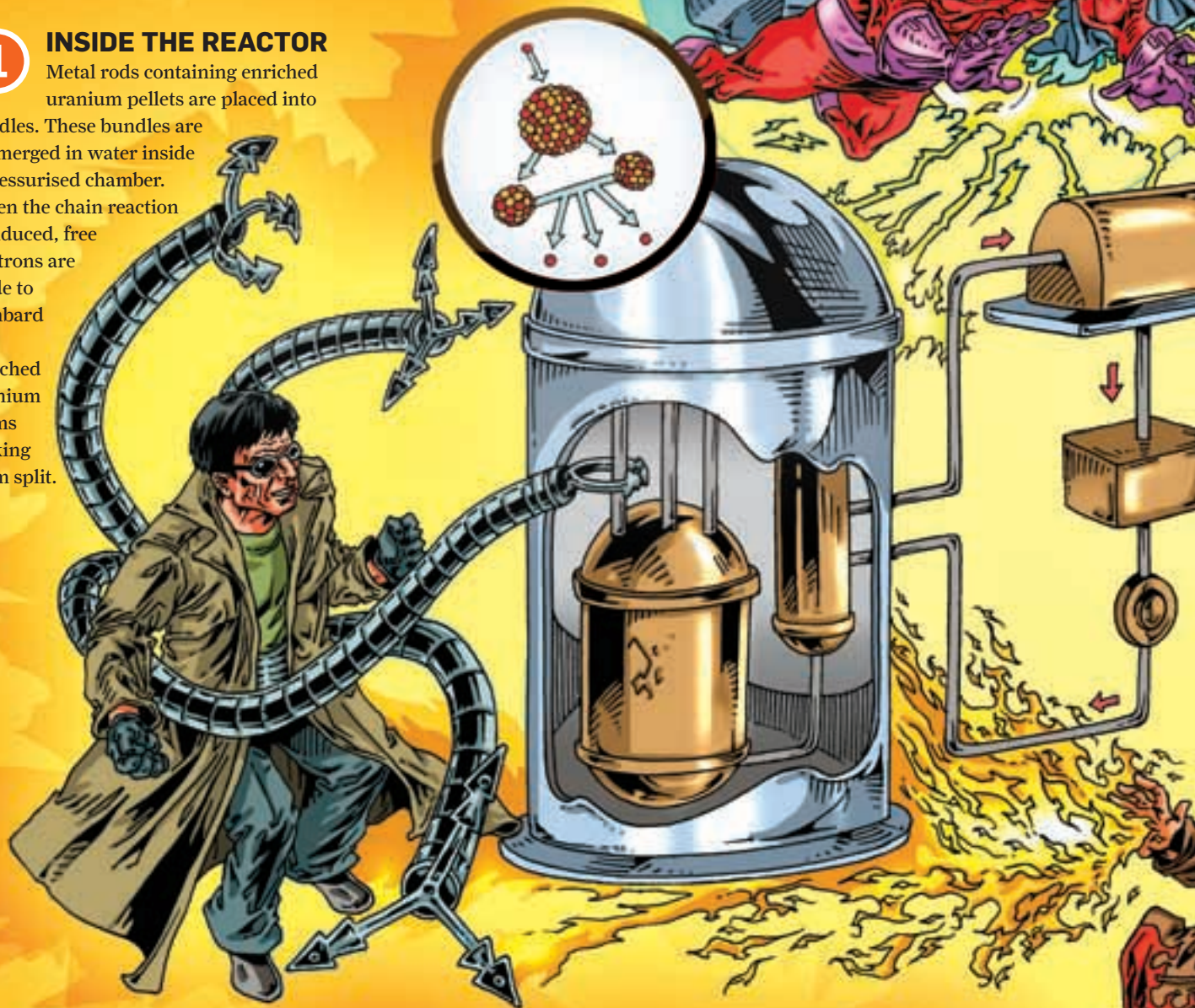


Nuclear Reactors: The Dark side

Nuclear reactors are considered pretty evil these days. What if they were really run by supervillains?

1 INSIDE THE REACTOR

Metal rods containing enriched uranium pellets are placed into bundles. These bundles are submerged in water inside a pressurised chamber. When the chain reaction is induced, free neutrons are made to bombard the enriched uranium atoms making them split.



2 THE CHAIN REACTION

The split atoms produce more free neutrons which in turn make more atoms split known as a chain reaction. The water here works to slow the neutrons (for better fission) and also acts as a coolant.

3 PYRO BURNS IT UP

This splitting or fission reaction releases enormous amounts of heat energy. This heat is used to raise the temperature of water to high levels without letting it turn to steam by applying high pressure.